

FLASHES IN PHOTOGRAPHY

A look at one of the most essential tools of a photographer

The simple flash is one of the most recognisable features in photography; from kids to the elderly, everyone knows when to smile right before the flash comes on, and flashes have indeed been used since forever to enhance the appearance of photographic subjects. Flashes exist to illuminate your photograph, thus any source that provides a short burst of artificial light within a certain colour range can be called a Flash. Almost all of today's dSLR cameras have inbuilt flashes, with a standardised accessory mounting bracket generally provided to allow an external flash unit, an option you commonly see being used by professionals at weddings, parties and other indoor events.

Let us first see how the camera flash actually works. From times when flash powder consisting of magnesium was literally ignited by hand to experimental high current flash LEDs, flash technologies camera have come a long way. The basic electronic flashtube setup you will find in most cameras broadly consists of a small battery for power supply, a gas discharge